



Emerging Technologies: Enhanced by Open Source

Here are five more emerging technologies that open source developers need to closely watch, and contribute to, in 2014.

Emerging technologies need innovation, and what better route to innovation nirvana than the open way! Open source technologies enable people from across the globe to innovate, contribute and enhance emerging technologies, eventually making them mainstream. In the previous issue, we featured five such emerging technology trends to watch, and contribute to, in 2014. Here are five more.

Putting Android to Bigger Use

Trend: Android, the Linux-based operating system for touch devices, smartphones and tablets, needs no introduction! It has earned a lot of fans because of the extremely large collection of free and open source apps available for Android users. You also have the ability to use the Android platform for various location-based sensor networks, home automation and social

innovations. It is used for fitness apps, navigation and other location apps, social groups, and more. Android is also useful beyond the mobile space, in embedded applications such as smart TVs, cameras, wearable computing devices, gaming consoles and car infotainment solutions. The success of Texas Instruments' Beaglebone and Google's projects such as Android@Home, Google Glass and Google TV showcases this trend. The most interesting development, however, is Android's growing acceptance in the enterprise space. With beefed up security features such as device encryption, the platform is growing as an effective tool for connecting employees with enterprise solutions, while on the go.

Trend+: I know somebody who uses an Android-based app to stealthily switch off the set-top box when his son has been glued to the TV for too long. But, that's only the tip of